

What Do They Do?

A detective game about jobs, syllables and the tools they use.



Ages 5 to 8

8 UK jobs

Clap • build • match

A baker, a vet, a postie and more. Clap the syllables, build each word from its tiles, then match every worker to their tool and their place.

How to play, and the grown up guide



Detective, we have a case to crack. Eight workers have lost the words for their jobs. Clap out the beats in each job, build the word from its syllable tiles, then work out where each worker goes and what they hold. Trust the clues, take your time, and every case gets solved.

1 • CLAP THE SYLLABLES

Say each job out loud and clap once for every beat. BA KER is two claps. VET is one. Clapping helps young readers hear the parts of a word before they read it.

2 • BUILD THE WORD

Cut out the syllable tiles on each job card along the dashed lines. Push them together in order to make the whole word, then write it in the letter boxes.

3 • MATCH THE WORKER TO THEIR PLACE AND THEIR TOOL

Each card shows where the worker goes and one tool they use. Talk about it together. A baker works at a bakery and holds a rolling pin. A vet works at an animal clinic and holds a bandage. Then the big matching page brings all eight together in a mixed up order to solve.

GROWN UP TIPS

Read it together. For younger detectives, clap and say the words with them and let them slot the tiles. For older ones, hand it over and let them cut, build and match on their own. Praise the effort of sounding a word out, not just getting it right. Laminate the pages and use a dry wipe pen so the mission plays again and again.

ANSWER KEY • GROWN UPS ONLY

BA KER makes BAKER • 2 claps • bakery • rolling pin DOC TOR makes DOCTOR • 2 claps • surgery • stethoscope

FARM ER makes FARMER • 2 claps • farm • tractor TEACH ER makes TEACHER • 2 claps • classroom • book

BUILD ER makes BUILDER • 2 claps • building site • hammer VET makes VET • 1 clap • animal clinic • bandage

CHEF makes CHEF • 1 clap • kitchen • frying pan POST IE makes POSTIE • 2 claps • post office • letters

Match page answers: A to 1 • B to 4 • C to 8 • D to 7 • E to 2 • F to 6 • G to 3 • H to 5.

Cut the syllable tiles and build each word

JOB 1

2 CLAPS



BAKER

× CUT

BA

+

KER

MAKES

WORKS AT



a bakery

USES



a rolling pin

JOB 2

2 CLAPS



DOCTOR

× CUT

DOC

+

TOR

MAKES

WORKS AT



a surgery

USES



a stethoscope

Cut the syllable tiles and build each word

JOB 3

2 CLAPS

FARMER



✂ CUT

FARM

+

ER

MAKES

WORKS AT



a farm

USES



a tractor

JOB 4

2 CLAPS

TEACHER



✂ CUT

TEACH

+

ER

MAKES

WORKS AT



a classroom

USES



a book

Cut the syllable tiles and build each word

JOB 5

2 CLAPS

BUILDER



× CUT

BUILD

+

ER

MAKES

WORKS AT



a building site

USES



a hammer

JOB 6

1 CLAP

VET



× CUT

VET

MAKES

WORKS AT



an animal clinic

USES



a bandage

Cut the syllable tiles and build each word

JOB 7

1 CLAP



CHEF

× CUT

CHEF

MAKES

WORKS AT



a kitchen

USES



a frying pan

JOB 8

2 CLAPS



POSTIE

× CUT

POST

+

IE

MAKES

WORKS AT



a post office

USES



letters

Match the worker to their tool

Eight workers, eight tools, all mixed up. Draw a line from each worker on the left to the one tool they use on the right. Say the job as you go. Grown ups, the answers are on the guide page.

A



Baker

rolling pin 

1

B



Doctor

hammer 

2

C



Farmer

frying pan 

3

D



Teacher

stethoscope 

4

E



Builder

letters 

5

F



Vet

bandage 

6

G



Chef

book 

7

H



Postie

tractor 

8

How many claps in each job?

Say each job out loud, slowly. Clap once for every beat you hear. The gold dots show you how many beats there are. Write the number of claps in the box. BA KER has two beats, so it is two claps.

BA KER**DOC TOR****FARM ER****TEACH ER****BUILD ER****VET****CHEF****POST IE**